Committed to professional development and opportunities for all Cuban EFL teachers

NEWSLETTER

Vol . No. 2 May-June 2026

EDITOR´S VOICE: **Really, really proud of the many achievements and activities that the APC ELI has done in 2026. A very fruitful and astonishing year . Five APC-ELI leaders were present at IATEFL. Some were part of the British Council sponsored team and others went as individuals .**

It was very inspiring to hear the announcement about the benefits and achievements APC-ELI had with the grant provided by IATEFL to the Kinship:Learning English in the family project.

The British Council continues supporting and sponsoring activities in favor of the English Language teachers, as it happended with the Second Dreamers Colloquium led by Yuliet Pons, the APC-ELI rep in Havana which resulted in a lively and unique fest in which the Primary, Junior and Senior High teachers made their presentations and several school children made their own presentations which supported all what those breve teachers have done . Once again, our note of gratitude to the extraordinary teachers, the APC-ELI members and non- members who have encouraged us to keep providing professional opportunities to all Cuban teachers of English.

Thanks to the Department of Education of Foreign Languages at Varona Pedagogical University for the support provided.





Second Dreamers Colloquium in Pabellon Cuba, May 7-8, 2026. An excellent performance of teachers and students.



Forthcoming events.

- *The Board suggests every single APC ELI Provincial representation to make the necessary coordination with the schools, universities and communities of youngsters and adults in their regions to celebrate the GREEN MONTH to honor the environment in June. You are welcome to share your ideas.*

Forthcoming events.

COMING ACTIVITY	Format	Time/Month	Participants
The Green Month	Face2face	May-June	Teachers, students and parents
OET teacher training	Face2face	June/July (*)	Selected EMP Teachers
Two cultures hand in hand contest	Online/F2F	Oct.-Nov	Students and teachers
British Week in Cuba	Face2face	December	General public/Selected centers
8th APC-ELI National Conference	Online/F2F	Dec 10-11	Teachers and EFL undergrads

(*) Still to be confirmed due to the existing siituation

If interested to coordinate any APC-ELI local activity or need some support for your local teaching event, please share your proposal and send the information to apcelioficial@gmail.com or inglescubatv@infomed.sld.cu. We will do our best to help

The new 2026 APC-ELI board

With the new organization changes , the Board has been reduced to 5 main posts

Chairperson: E. Garbey Savigne, PhD, MA, -Havana Medical University
Organizing Officer: Maria de los Angeles Reyes, MEd - Manuel Fajardo Medical School
Professional Development and Research Officer: Isora Enriquez O´Farrill, PhD -Varona Pedagogical University
Conference and Events Officer: Diana Rosa Morales , PhD, - UCLV Martha Abreu
Digital and Marketing Officer: Ana Iris Testa Gonzalez , MSc, - Julio Trigo Medical School

The APC-ELI board thanks Mayda Ramos for her time as the Internal and Liasion Relations Officer

Opportunities for Continuous Professional Development

Believe it or not!!???. Once again, APC ELI has been given a conditional grant for an award to lead the project known as *ESP Teacher Training Course to qualify Cuban nurses for overseas missions*. The association has completed its needs analysis process and it is now getting ready for the implementation of the project

APC-ELI complies with its motto to provide Continuous Professional Development (CPD) and it is pleased to announce the IATEFL SCHOLARSHIPS for 2027. Read the information below and google the links Wish you good luck!!

GENERAL INFORMATION

You can find out about each of the scholarships by visiting our [IATEFL Scholarships page](https://www.iatefl.org/wp-json/civicrm/v3/url?u=22616&qid=2163455).

Once you have chosen which scholarship(s) to apply for, login to the [IATEFL website](https://www.iatefl.org/wp-json/civicrm/v3/url?u=22617&qid=2163455), then click on "Apply for Scholarship" displayed on your dashboard.

FOR SOME OF THE SCHOLARSHIPS, TEACHERS HAVE TO BE IATEFL MEMBERS, (MARKED WITH **)

The submission deadline is **16.00 (UK time) on Wednesday 17 June 2026**. Early submissions are very welcome; late submissions will not be considered.

The result of your application will be emailed to you between **11 and 21 August 2026**. Please do NOT contact the IATEFL Head Office about scholarship decisions; the Scholarship Committee will send everyone the results as soon as they are available.

Please note: the prizes included in these scholarships **are not paid in advance** and **may not cover the entire cost** of your trip.

Please consider if you are able to pay the costs upfront and make up the difference if necessary.

Also consider other costs that may be involved as part of your trip, such as visa applications. If included, here is how each element works:

1 Year's IATEFL Membership - activated after the conference Accommodation –

Option 1: book through IATEFL (no upfront cost)

Option 2: be reimbursed against receipts at the Winners' Gathering (Tuesday 6 April 2027) Pre-Conference Event (PCE) - book your place for free, your sponsor will cover it Flights/Travel - you will need to pay for these yourself and submit receipts.

You will be reimbursed at the Winners' Gathering (Tuesday 6 April 2027) Conference - book your place for free, your sponsor will cover it Cash £ - this will be presented to you at the Winners' Gathering (Tuesday 6 April 2027)

IATEFL Gillian Porter Ladousse Scholarship (**)

This scholarship was set up by the Teacher Training and Education SIG (TTEd SIG) in 1999. The driving force behind the conference fund was Gillian Porter Ladousse who was Coordinator of the SIG at the time. The fund, which was named the Gillian Porter Ladousse Scholarship after Gillian's untimely death in 2002, was set up to enable a teacher trainer who is a member of TTEd SIG to attend the IATEFL Conference.

The scholarship consists of:

- registration for the TTEd Pre-Conference Event
- registration for the IATEFL Conference
- GBP 1575.00 towards conference related expenses

To qualify you must:

- be an individual member of IATEFL and a member of TTEd SIG
- be a trainer with between three and fifteen years' experience in ELT
- agree to give a talk or workshop on an aspect of teacher training during the IATEFL conference
- agree to write a article for the TTEd SIG newsletter on your talk by the end of April 2027
- agree to write an article for the TTEd SIG newsletter on how attending the conference affected your programme of work in your local context by December 2027

To be considered, you must submit:

- a speaker proposal by the scholarship deadline
- a training session plan that you have delivered in the last 12 months with an accompanying set of notes. This can be any length of session, on any topic, for any group of teachers, trainers, etc. that you have worked with in a training capacity. Please also include a set of notes (maximum 1000 words), detailing your rationale behind the session and your reflections on how it went

IATEFL Gill Sturtridge First-Time Speaker Scholarship (**)

This scholarship is awarded from the donations given in her memory by the family and friends of Gill Sturtridge. The purpose of this scholarship is to encourage a member of IATEFL to give his/her first talk at an IATEFL Conference.

The scholarship consists of:

- registration for a Pre-Conference Event of the winner's choice
- registration for the IATEFL Conference
- GBP 1050.00 towards conference related expenses

To qualify you must:

- be a newcomer to the profession with between three and ten years' experience in ELT
- be an Individual, Student, Retired, Early Career Teacher or associate member of IATEFL who has not previously presented at the IATEFL Conference
- agree to give a talk at the IATEFL Conference
- agree to write a 250 - 500-word article by the end of April 2027 for possible publication in IATEFL Voices. You may like to write about the highlights of the conference or about how attending the conference has affected your approach to work in your home country.

To be considered, you must submit:

- an online speaker proposal on a topic of your choice by the scholarship deadline
- a 400 – 500 word essay:
    - describing a recent successful lesson you have given
    - listing the factors that made it successful
    - drawing broad conclusions regarding your future teaching practice

LAMSIG early career

We believe that learning organisations need learning leaders and managers which is why the IATEFL Leadership and Management Special Interest Group (LAMSIG) is offering a scholarship to support an early-career ELT leader who is not otherwise funded to attend the IATEFL conference and LAMSIG Pre-Conference Event (PCE) in 2027. This scholarship is particularly aimed at ELT professionals who are **new to leading and managing**, having been appointed to their **first formal leadership or management role within the last 2 years**. Reflection and sharing are key elements of consolidating our learning, and after gaining new perspectives at the Conference and PCE, we would like you to actively contribute to the learning of others by writing for our LAMSIG Blog and participating in a LAMSIG Live! interview to be broadcast on our social media channels.

The scholarship consists of:

- registration for the LAMSIG Pre-Conference Event
- registration for the IATEFL Conference
- a year's IATEFL membership
- a year's LAMSIG membership
- GBP 850.00 towards accommodation and travel costs

To qualify you must:

- be a practising ELT leader/manager within the first 2 years of your first formal leadership role
- agree to participate in LAMSIG Live! after the conference
- agree to write an article of between 500-1000 words on your conference experience to be considered for publication on the LAMSIG Blog, post-conference (this is a key piece of the scholarship)
- agree to participate in the promotion of the following year's conference (for example with a brief video)
- agree to write a further article of similar length 12 months after the conference on how you followed up on your conference experience, to be considered for publication on the LAMSIG Blog

To be considered you must submit:

- a description of your current role (100-200 words)
- your curriculum vitae (please include a link to an online document)
- an essay of between 400 and 500 words responding to the following question: "As an early-career leader, what would you gain from attending the conference and how would others around you benefit?"

LAMSIG Scholarship (**)

This scholarship is for a person in an ELT leadership/management role, such as Director of Studies, Academic Manager, Summer School Organiser or similar, to attend the IATEFL Conference.

This scholarship is funded by the IATEFL Leadership and Management Special Interest Group (LAMSIG) with the aim of assisting managers not otherwise funded to attend conference - because we believe that learning organisations need learning managers. We would like you to both present – thereby enhancing the body of knowledge in our profession – and attend – thereby gaining from the learning opportunities presented by the conference, and in such a way that you can pass the learning on to others in your school/context.

The scholarship consists of:

- registration for the LAMSIG Pre-Conference Event
- registration for the IATEFL Conference
- a year's IATEFL membership
- a year's LAMSIG membership
- GBP 850.00 towards accommodation and travel costs

To qualify you must:

- be a practising ELT manager
- agree to give a presentation that will form part of the LAMSIG Showcase
- agree to write an article of between 500-1000 words on your conference presentation topic, to be considered for publication in the LAMSIG newsletter post-conference (this is a key piece of the scholarship)
- agree to participate in the promotion of the following year's conference (for example with a brief video)
- agree to write a further article of similar length 12 months after the conference on how you followed up on your conference experience, to be considered for publication in the LAMSIG newsletter

To be considered you must submit:

- a speaker proposal for a talk or workshop at the conference on ELT leadership / management by the scholarship deadline
- an essay of between 400 and 500 words responding to the following question: "What would you gain from attending the conference and how will others around you benefit?"

2027 PronSIG Classroom Action Research Scholarship

Learning a language is a lifelong journey. As we pass from early childhood through adolescence, adulthood, and into seniorhood, our voices evolve alongside our identities, experiences, and communicative needs. Teaching pronunciation therefore requires sensitivity to age, context, motivation, and the changing goals learners bring to the classroom.

With this in mind, PronSIG's 2027 scholarship is inspired by our 2026 PCE theme 'Lifelong voices: Teaching pronunciation from childhood to seniorhood'. We invite educators to explore how pronunciation teaching can support learners at different stages of their life, whether that be young learners just discovering their voices, teenagers shaping their identities, adults refining professional communication, or senior learners embracing new linguistic challenges.

In thinking about your interest in this area, maybe …

- you would like to explore the efficacy of different pronunciation teaching strategies across age groups in your context;
- you want to create, adapt and/or trial resources designed specifically for children, adolescents, adults, or senior learners and evaluate their impact;
- you wish to investigate how pronunciation teaching can better support learners' communicative goals at different points in their lives.

If this resonates with your teaching context and curiosity, this scholarship offers an opportunity to explore how we can support lifelong voices in meaningful and research-informed ways and share your findings.

If this sounds like you, then apply for the 2027 IATEFL PronSIG Action Research Scholarship!

What we want:

We are inviting classroom-based action research proposals that expand our understanding of pronunciation teaching at any age. In line with the theme 'Lifelong voices: Teaching pronunciation from childhood to seniorhood', we are particularly interested in projects that explore how age shapes pronunciation learning and teaching in different contexts.

The word research can sound intimidating, but classroom-based action research is a practical and accessible form of professional development. It allows teachers to investigate questions that arise naturally in their own classrooms, reflect systematically on their practice, and contribute to our collective knowledge as a professional community.

You will receive support and mentoring to design and carry out a focused action research project related to your context, and to write an article sharing your findings in PronSIG's journal, *Speak Out!*.

What you'll need:

- An idea, question, or set of activities related to pronunciation teaching at a particular age / life stage (or across different ages).
- A classroom setting in which you can carry out your action research.
- The time and motivation to conduct a small-scale, manageable research project.

What you'll receive:

- registration for the PronSIG Pre-Conference Event
- registration for the IATEFL Conference
- GBP 1000.00 towards your travel, accommodation and any other conference-related expenses
- A session to present your research at a future/upcoming PronSIG event.
- Support and mentoring to plan and complete your classroom-based action research project.
- Support and mentoring to publish your findings in PronSIG's biannual journal *Speak Out!*.

To qualify you must:

- be an individual member of IATEFL and a member of PronSIG.

Access to the scholarship is a benefit of membership, and as such, we cannot accept proposals from those who are not part of the SIG.

To be considered you must submit:

- A research proposal via the PronSIG Google Form
- A confirmation of submission via your IATEFL dashboard

The submission deadline is **16.00 (UK time) on Wednesday 17 June 2026**. Early submissions are very welcome; late submissions will not be considered.

The result of your application will be emailed to you between **11 and 21 August 2026**. Please do NOT contact the IATEFL Head Office about scholarship decisions; the Scholarship Committee will send everyone the results as soon as they are available.

TDSIG Early Career Teacher Scholarship

Teacher development can come fast and steep in the first years of our professional careers. This scholarship, funded by the IATEFL Teacher Development Special Interest Group, acknowledges this teacher development slope, experienced by a recent graduate of a pre-service teacher training program and who is now early in their career. We aim to reward the dedication towards and effort on teaching training program coursework as well as the passion and zeal exhibited in how theory was applied practically in the classroom, and for their own and their peers' professional development within the field of ELT.

The scholarship consists of:

- IATEFL TDSIG Membership (as full individual IATEFL membership or additional SIG)
- Registration for the TDSIG Pre-Conference Event
- Registration for the IATEFL Conference
- 1,050.00 GBP towards conference-related expenses

To qualify you must:

- Have graduated in the past 5 years from a pre-service teacher training program that is accredited by a respected and recognized accreditation body, as viewed by the IATEFL TDSIG scholarship committee;
- Have **up to** 5 years teaching experience
- Be a first-time IATEFL Conference attendee (not an Associate conference)
- Agree to do these things:
    - to be interviewed in advance of the conference to introduce yourself and your teaching/studying context, as well as at and after it to describe your experiences and takeaways as a participant. Both interviews may be recorded and used by TDSIG and/or IATEFL in their websites and social media platforms, at their discretion.
    - to create a video narrative of one minute length about your experiences as a new teacher - challenges, successes and ongoing areas of interest or curiosity
    - to produce a written reflective piece after the conference, in which you should focus on how your experiences at the conference have furthered your development - and how you intend on sharing this learning opportunity with your peers in your local teaching context.

All three pieces may be used by TDSIG for various uses in promotional material.

To be considered you must submit:

a) A short piece of about 400 - 500 words, where you should clearly include: a description of your pre-service teacher training program; how you believe that attending the conference would impact / help you impact your teaching context and community.

b) A disclosure about any use of AI in writing the application. The disclosure should state whether or not AI/LLM was used and if so, which tool, for what task, and where; failure to disclose can be an integrity violation.

Testing, Evaluation and Assessment (**)

IATEFL TEASIG Scholarships are awarded to encourage and support teachers involved in testing and assessment to attend the IATEFL Conference. TEASIG strongly believes in helping to promote teachers with an active interest in testing and assessment, and provides scholarships for this purpose.

Applicants should have an active interest and participate in testing and/or assessment, or be involved in studies and research in this field. The successful applicant should be prepared to contribute to TEASIG's activities such as writing an article for the *TEA Today*, presenting a TEASIG webinar, or helping to support local events on Testing, Evaluation and Assessment in their home areas.

The scholarship consists of

- registration for the TEASIG Pre-Conference Event
- registration for the IATEFL Conference
- membership of IATEFL and TEASIG for one year
- GBP 850 towards conference-related expenses

To qualify you must

- be an individual member of IATEFL, preferably a TEASIG member
- have an active professional interest in testing and assessment, with a desire to participate actively in TEASIG
- prepare and give a talk or workshop during the TEASIG Showcase on any aspect of testing and assessment from your own experience or studies
- be present during the TEASIG Open Forum during the TEASIG Showcase day
- write a 1000-2000 word report on your talk/workshop for the TEASIG 'TEA Today' publication.

To be considered you should submit

- an online speaker proposal on a testing and/or assessment topic by the scholarship deadline
- a 400-500-word essay in which you:
  - outline your interest and experience in testing and assessment
  - describe how this has impacted on your own teaching context
  - describe how you could bring your own experience to the benefit of TEASIG
  - optional: consider challenges you have faced in testing and assessment and how you have overcome these.

We strongly discourage the inclusion of AI-generated material in applications for the IATEFL TEASIG Scholarship. It is important that your own voice comes through in your application. Submissions that rely on AI-generated text may be disadvantaged in the review process, as the selection committee values authenticity, originality, and personal reflection.

The IATEFL TTEdSIG Early-Career Teacher Educator Scholarship (**)

The aim of the Early-Career Teacher Educator Scholarship, set up by The Teacher Training and Education Special Interest Group, is to provide early-career teacher educators with an opportunity to attend the TTEdSIG PCE, give a short 20-minute presentation at the PCE, and attend the IATEFL conference.

The scholarship consists of:

This scholarship is for early-career teacher educators, which the TTEdSIG defines as teacher educators who have been in their position or have been carrying out their role for no more than five years. One does not need to have the defined position of 'Teacher Educator' or 'Teacher Trainer' to be considered a teacher educator. Additionally, to be considered for this scholarship, you must be a member of the TTEdSIG.

To qualify you must:

- Registration for the TTEdSIG Pre-Conference Event
  Registration for the IATEFL Conference
- IATEFL TTEdSIG membership (as full individual IATEFL membership or additional SIG)
  750 GBP towards accommodation, expenses, and travel costs

- Be a current IATEFL member and a member of TTEdSIG
  Be an early-career teacher educator who has been:
  - working in the position of or performing the role of a teacher educator for less than five years
  - involved in teacher education and/or training for less than five years

  Agree to do these things:
  - Give a 20-minute presentation or lead a workshop at the TTEdSIG PCE (the content of which is linked to the essay you write for the scholarship)
  - Complete a short, recorded interview with the TTEdSIG team, discussing your experience
  - Write a 600-word reflective article for the TTEdSIG newsletter

To be considered you must submit:

- A training session plan that you have delivered in the last 12 months with an accompanying set of notes. This can be any length of session, on any topic, for any group of teachers, trainers, etc. that you have worked with in a training capacity. Please also include a set of notes (maximum 1000 words), detailing your rationale behind the session and your reflections on how it went

Trinity College London-Friederike Sell Scholarship

The aim of this scholarship funded by Trinity College London, in memory of Dr Friederike Sell, is to enable an ELT professional to present their work to a wider audience by giving a presentation related to 'pragmatic competence in assessment', suitable for inclusion in the Testing, Evaluation and Assessment Showcase at the IATEFL Conference. 'Pragmatic competence' refers to the ability to use linguistic forms to fulfil a desired communicative function in a manner that is appropriate in a given context (Council of Europe, 2001).

The scholarship consists of:

- registration for the TEASIG Pre-Conference Event
- registration for the IATEFL Conference
- a year's IATEFL membership
- GBP 1050.00 towards conference related expenses

To qualify you must:

- be an ELT professional working in examinations and assessment development
- agree to give a talk or a workshop on an aspect of pragmatic competence in EL examinations and assessment on the TEASIG Showcase in the IATEFL Conference

To be considered, you must submit:

- a speaker proposal related to 'pragmatic competence in assessment', suitable for inclusion in the Testing, Evaluation and Assessment Special Interest Group Showcase, by the scholarship deadline
- an essay of between 400 and 500 words explaining:
    1. your approach to assessment and/or exams
    2. why it is particularly innovative or relevant to teachers of English in a specific region, or to a general audience of teachers
    3. why it will be of interest to IATEFL's international audience

Note: If AI was used to generate text or ideas for any part of your application, please declare which AI system was used and how it was used in an addendum to the 'References' section.

Trinity College London Teacher Education Scholarship

The aim of this scholarship funded by Trinity College London, is to enable a practising teacher educator to present their work relating to innovative teacher education practice to a wider audience by giving a presentation suitable for inclusion in the Teacher Training and Education Special Interest Group Showcase at the IATEFL Conference.

The award consists of:

- registration for the TTEd SIG Pre-Conference Event
- registration for the IATEFL Conference
- a year's IATEFL membership
- GBP 1050.00 towards conference related expenses

To qualify you must:

- be a trainer/teacher educator working in the field of teacher education
- agree to give a talk or a workshop on an innovative aspect of Teacher Education at the TTEd SIG Showcase

To be considered, you must submit:

- a speaker proposal by the scholarship deadline
- an essay of between 400 and 500 words explaining innovative teacher education practice you have developed or a specific case study on a new way of working. This may be relevant to teacher educators and/or CPD trainers in a specific region, or to a wider group of teacher educators/trainers.